THE EQUITY EXPRESSION OF THE AI CAPEX THESIS

The Rival Borrower

For three years the argument about artificial-intelligence infrastructure has been an argument about demand. Would anyone pay enough for the tokens to justify the machines? That question has quietly been answered in the affirmative by the most unglamorous data series available: South Korean customs receipts. In August, Korea shipped **US$46.65bn** of semiconductors, a record, up **209%** on a year earlier and 47.5% of everything the country sold abroad. Memory is roughly half of AI capital spending. Memory is going out of the door faster than it ever has.

The question has changed. It is no longer whether the buildout is real. It is who lends it the money, and at what price, now that the borrower has become large enough to compete with the United States Treasury.

A reframe worth holding onto

The internal Wiki's September reading is that Big Tech has stopped being a capital-markets bystander and become a rival issuer. Greed & Fear (3 September) argues the AI capex cycle is *inflationary now* because "the hyperscalers' demand for long-term funding is now competing with the federal government." The White Box note of 7 September puts it more bluntly, citing JPMorgan Asset Management: Big Tech bonds and SPVs "already emit more than 50% of what the USG does," and "this 'fight' is pushing the cost of debt up for both."

Both are named providers' views, not forecasts, and neither is independently verified here.

Method — External figures in this edition are taken from company releases, exchange data and dated news reporting, and each carries its as-of date. Internal figures and arguments come from the Heyokha research Wiki and are attributed to the provider who made them (Greed & Fear / Chris Wood; The White Box / Ignacio de Gregorio; CLSA; 13D Research), and are labelled as views. Where the two conflict, both are stated and the conflict is left standing. No figure appears here that could not be traced to a dated source.

Picture a market town with one building society. For decades the council has borrowed there to resurface roads and rebuild the school, at the lowest rate in the district, because everyone assumes a council cannot fail. Then a factory arrives — profitable, growing, wanting four more sheds by spring — and starts borrowing from the same society, in size. Deposits have not grown. Every pound lent to the factory is a pound not lent to the council, which must roll over an enormous debt each year and now has to offer more. The factory, being merely a company, offers more still. Both pay up, and the fifth shed — the marginal one, which only just cleared the old hurdle rate — never gets built. Nothing went wrong with the factory's products; the queue at the gate is longer than ever. What changed is the price of money, and the factory is why it changed.

THE STORY IN 60 SECONDS

$46.65bn

Korean chip exports in August — a record, +209.0% y/y, 47.5% of all exports. *Korea Customs, 1 Sep 2026.*

4.78%

US 10-year Treasury yield, after a 20-month high near 4.79% this month. *Trading Economics, 8 Sep 2026.*

$638bn

Oracle's backlog, the cycle's largest, ahead of results on 10 September. *Analyst previews, Sep 2026.*

WHAT ACTUALLY HAPPENED

Two prints, pointing opposite ways

On 1 September, Korea published its August trade data. Semiconductor shipments rose 209.0% year on year to $46.65bn, the third consecutive month above $40bn and the fifteenth consecutive month of growth. Total exports climbed 68.7% to $98.25bn and the trade surplus reached $34.75bn, the nineteenth straight month in surplus. Shipments to China were up 119.3% and to the United States 89.3%. Korea manufactures roughly two-thirds of the world's DRAM between two companies; global DRAM revenue reached $154.73bn in the second quarter, a 59.5% sequential increase. If the AI buildout were decelerating, this is the series in which it would show up first, and it is accelerating.

On the same tape, the cost of financing that buildout was moving the other way. The 10-year Treasury yield reached a one-year high near 4.8% in the opening days of September, and on 1 September Oracle fell 4% on the move — a mechanical response to the fact that Oracle funded $56bn of fiscal-2026 capital spending with roughly $43bn of borrowing, leaving it the most leveraged of the mega-cap builders. Investment-grade spreads on Amazon, Microsoft, Meta and Alphabet paper widened towards 80 basis points over Treasuries from around 50 earlier in the year. Alphabet's August bond sale raised $25bn against a peak order book of about $115bn; the deal cleared, but it cleared at a price.

The mechanism joining the two prints is straightforward. Hyperscaler free cash flow no longer covers hyperscaler capital spending. Alphabet has guided 2026 capital expenditure to $195–205bn, raised twice this year, and reported its first negative free cash flow since listing. The gap is filled in the bond market. Through July, the largest cloud and AI issuers had sold roughly $194bn of bonds, up about 79% on the same period of 2025; by early September the running total was reported at approximately $220bn. Against a 2020–2024 average of around $35bn a year, and $93bn in the whole of 2025, this is not a change of degree.

And the marginal buyer of that paper is the same institution that buys Treasuries. That is the entire argument. The AI trade has graduated from an equity story about earnings into a fixed-income story about supply.

> THE ESSENTIAL DISTINCTION
>
> Demand risk and financing risk are not the same risk, and they are currently pointing in opposite directions. The Korean export data says demand is fine. The credit spreads say the money is getting dearer. A cycle can be simultaneously *working* and *unaffordable* — and the second condition ends it just as surely as the first would.

THE MECHANISM

One gigawatt, traced from concrete to coupon

1 · Build the gigawatt

A gigawatt of AI compute costs roughly $50bn to construct, a figure NVIDIA's chief executive has said is heading towards $100bn. That is land, shells, transformers, cooling, and silicon.

→

2 · Memory takes half

Because inference is memory-bound rather than compute-bound, memory is now the largest single line — expected to exceed 50% of AI investment next year. This is why the bill lands in Korea.

→

3 · Cash runs out

Operating cash flow no longer covers it. Oracle funded $56bn of FY26 capex with ~$43bn of debt; Alphabet went FCF-negative. The balance is issued as bonds.

→

4 · The coupon sets the hurdle

That bond must clear against a 4.78% Treasury plus a spread that has widened from ~50bp to ~80bp. The hurdle rate on the next gigawatt rises with it.

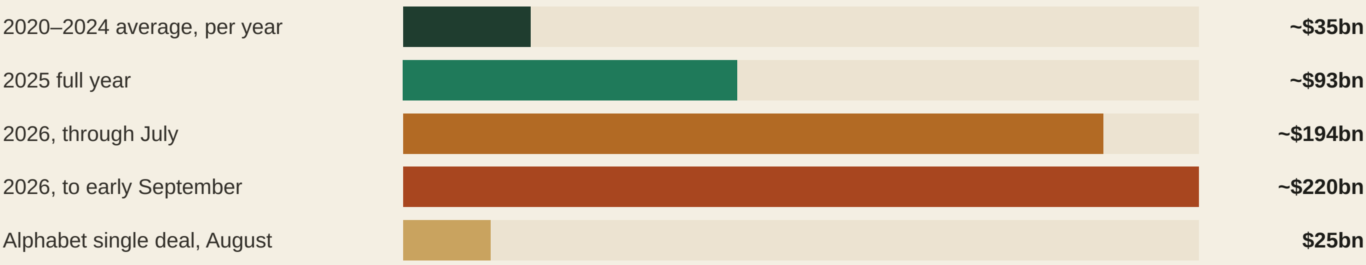
Sources — Step 1 and Step 2 figures are internal Wiki records of The White Box (Ignacio de Gregorio), 4 June and 7 September 2026, and are the provider's estimates, not verified externally. Step 3 external: Oracle capex and debt per news reporting, 1 Sep 2026; Alphabet free cash flow per company results, Jul 2026. Step 4: Trading Economics, 8 Sep 2026, and dated spread reporting, Sep 2026.

$220bn	~80bp	$96.2bn
Approximate hyperscaler bond issuance in 2026 to early September. The 2020–2024 annual average was about $35bn. *Reported issuance tallies, Sep 2026.*	Spread over Treasuries on large-cap tech paper, widened from around 50bp earlier in 2026 as capex guidance was raised. *Dated credit reporting, Sep 2026.*	NVIDIA revenue in the quarter to 26 July 2026, +106% year on year; data centre $89.0bn, +117%. *NVIDIA Q2 FY27 release, 26 Aug 2026.*

The three numbers the argument turns on: the supply of new bonds, the price the market demands for them, and the revenue that is supposed to justify both.

THE CENTRAL COMPARISON

How fast the borrowing changed



Bond issuance by the largest cloud and AI issuers. Bars are illustrative and scaled to the largest value shown; period definitions differ between the sources compiling them and the tallies are not strictly like-for-like. Figures from dated issuance reporting, 2026. The Alphabet deal is shown for scale: one transaction in one month is now comparable to two-thirds of a typical pre-2025 year for the whole cohort.

A USEFUL MENTAL MODEL

Think of AI capital spending as a very large, very new bond issuer that happens to also make software. Judged as a technology story it is thriving. Judged as a credit — cash flow negative, backlog-dependent, funding a six-year asset with debt into a possible tightening cycle — it is a name most investors have never underwritten before, and are underwriting now whether they know it or not.

THE SHIFT

What has actually shifted

WHAT HAS CHANGED	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE IN THE DATA	WHY IT CUTS BOTH WAYS
Funding moved from cash to debt	Hyperscaler issuance from ~$35bn a year (2020–24) to ~$220bn in 2026 to date; Alphabet's first negative free cash flow since listing.	Debt lets the buildout continue past the limits of internal cash — and installs a lender with a claim, a covenant, and a coupon that reprices.
The buyer base overlaps with the Treasury's	Spreads on large-cap tech paper widened from ~50bp to ~80bp over Treasuries as capex guidance rose; the 10-year reached 4.78%.	It confirms that AI is now macro-relevant. It also means a bad Treasury auction is now an AI-equity event, and vice versa.

WHAT HAS CHANGED	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE IN THE DATA	WHY IT CUTS BOTH WAYS
Demand evidence got harder to dismiss	Korean semiconductor exports +209.0% year on year to a record $46.65bn in August; global DRAM revenue +59.5% quarter on quarter in Q2.	It refutes the "no real demand" bear case. It also concentrates a national economy, and a global supply chain, on one cohort of buyers.
Equities stopped rewarding capex	Oracle fell 4% on 1 September purely on a yield move; the Wiki records memory names trading well below highs despite record profits.	Discipline is arguably healthy and long overdue. It is also how a capex cycle stops — not through a demand shock but through a funding strike.
The macro calendar turned hostile	The FOMC meets 15–16 September with the market weighing a hold at 3.50–3.75% against a 25bp hike after hawkish remarks from the chair.	A hike would validate the "capex is inflationary" reading. It would also raise the discount rate on every gigawatt not yet built.

BOTH SIDES

Bull and bear, stated fairly

The bull case

- **The demand data is no longer arguable.** Korean semiconductor exports rose 209.0% year on year in August to a record $46.65bn, the fifteenth consecutive month of growth. Whatever else is uncertain, orders are being placed and shipped.
- **The unit economics improved.** The Wiki records The White Box reversing its own scepticism in July 2026: memory-centric architecture roughly triples tokens per second without a compute change, giving an estimated three-year payback against a six-year depreciation schedule. Alibaba's chief financial officer separately stated a similar payback in August.
- **The seller of the picks is delivering.** NVIDIA reported $96.2bn of revenue for the quarter to 26 July, up 106%, with data centre up 117% and gross margin at 75.0% — and guided to roughly $108bn for the current quarter, explicitly excluding any China data-centre compute.
- **The balance sheets are not stretched by IG standards.** Post-issuance leverage among the hyperscalers has been reported in the 0.4–0.7x range against an investment-grade average near 3x. The borrowing is large in absolute terms and small relative to the earnings behind it.
- **The books still clear.** Alphabet's August deal drew roughly $115bn of peak demand for $25bn of paper. Spreads widened, but there has been no failed auction and no closed window.
- **Value may be shifting to identifiable enablers.** The internal view holds that returns over the next five years accrue to bandwidth — memory, optics, fibre — with silicon photonics expected to reach half the optical transceiver market in 2027. That is a narrower and more testable claim than "AI wins".

The bear case

- **The cost of capital is rising into the peak of the spend.** Spreads have gone from ~50bp to ~80bp, the 10-year sits at 4.78%, and the Fed may raise on 16 September. Every one of those moves lifts the hurdle rate on capacity not yet committed.
- **The leverage is concentrated where the backlog is.** Oracle funded $56bn of FY26 capex with ~$43bn of debt and fell 4% on a single day's yield move. Its $638bn remaining performance obligation is an asset only if the counterparties pay.
- **Cash flow has already turned.** Alphabet reported its first negative free cash flow since listing while guiding capex to $195–205bn. A cycle funded from cash can be slowed; a cycle funded from debt has to be serviced.
- **The obligations extend well beyond the bonds.** The Wiki records CLSA's August work putting off-balance-sheet commitments at roughly $3tn — uncommenced leases plus purchase obligations — and a depreciation charge exceeding $520bn over three years. That is a provider estimate, not an audited figure, and it dwarfs the visible debt.
- **Demand is concentrated even where it is strong.** The same internal source that turned bullish on margins remains bearish on demand quality, noting hyperscaler backlogs lean heavily on a very small number of counterparties and that willingness to pay outside coding has been unremarkable.
- **The market is not paying for the results.** The Wiki notes memory producers trading far below highs despite record profits, which it reads as investors declining to capitalise earnings they do not believe are durable.

The internal Wiki's dedicated "bear case" section is well developed on demand and financing but was written before this month's data. The financing and rate points above were therefore built from external reporting dated 1–8 September 2026, and the concentration points from tensions visible inside the companies' own disclosures — a negative free cash flow line sitting beside a raised capex guide, a record backlog sitting beside a widening spread.

Where internal and external views diverge

The clearest conflict concerns what the Korean export boom means. The internal view of 7 September treats it as dispositive evidence against deceleration: if memory exports are exploding, the investment boom is not slowing.

External reporting on the same data, published 3 September, framed the tripling as a question rather than an answer — whether an economy and a supply chain now this dependent on one cohort of buyers has too much of a good thing. Both readings use the identical number. They differ on whether a record shipment is a signal of health or a measure of concentration. The Wiki's own bear material sharpens the problem rather than resolving it: an August note on the same page argues the gigawatt forecasts underlying these orders are themselves inflated by phantom interconnection queues and by inference migrating to local hardware in ways not priced into load projections. A second, unresolved tension sits inside the internal view itself — Greed & Fear holds that the capex cycle is inflationary now because of the physical inputs it consumes, while the same Wiki page records aggressive token price cuts of 20% to 80%, which are plainly disinflationary at the point of sale. This edition does not attempt to settle either.

THE DASHBOARD

What to watch from here

SIGNAL	PLAIN-ENGLISH READING	WHY IT MATTERS
Oracle Q1 FY27, 10 September	Whether the $638bn backlog converts to revenue, and what management says about funding the capex behind it.	The most leveraged builder reporting first. Its cost of debt is the cycle's marginal cost of debt.
FOMC decision, 16 September	A hold at 3.50–3.75% versus a 25bp hike, with the dot plot alongside.	A hike prices the "capex is inflationary" thesis directly into the discount rate on unbuilt capacity.
Large-cap tech credit spreads	Whether ~80bp over Treasuries is a plateau or a waypoint; watch order books as well as spreads.	Spreads, not sales, are the cycle's brake. A failed or pulled deal would be the first genuine stop signal.
Korean 10-day and 20-day export prints	The highest-frequency read on physical AI demand, published twice a month by Korea Customs.	Any sequential stall here would arrive weeks before it shows in any company's results.
Hyperscaler free cash flow	Whether Alphabet's negative quarter proves isolated or becomes the cohort's normal condition.	It determines how much of 2027's roughly $800bn-plus of spending has to be borrowed rather than earned.
Depreciation policy and useful-life assumptions	Any change to assumed asset lives on GPUs and data-centre equipment.	Reported AI earnings are highly sensitive to this assumption. A shortening would compress profits without any change in demand.

EXPRESSION

Three postures, not one answer

Own the physical bottleneck

Memory, optics and interconnect, on the argument that inference is bandwidth-constrained and the constraint is priced in export data before it is priced in equities. **The cost:** these are the most cyclical, most Korea-and-Taiwan-concentrated assets in the complex, and they fall hardest when the capex line is cut — as their drawdowns from highs, despite record profits, already show.

Own the creditor's side

Treat widening spreads as compensation and take the fixed-income exposure rather than the equity, on IG balance sheets carrying leverage well below the market average. **The cost:** the upside is capped at par while the off-balance-sheet commitments the Wiki flags remain unaudited and largely unquantified by anyone outside the companies.

Own what a funding squeeze pays for

Hold the assets that benefit if the rival-borrower dynamic pushes rates and inflation higher — the hard-asset and gold-linked expressions the internal providers have favoured through this period. **The cost:** it is a hedge against the financing thesis, not a participation in the technology, and it has already run a long way.

The companies named on the following pages are illustrative of the mechanisms described in this edition. They are NOT recommendations, and nothing here constitutes investment advice.

ORCL

Oracle Corporation

RPO $638bn
Results 10 Sep 2026

The purest expression of the debt-funded buildout. Roughly $43bn of borrowing funded $56bn of fiscal-2026 capital spending, leaving Oracle the most leveraged of the mega-cap builders and the one whose share price now moves on the 10-year yield: it fell 4% on 1 September on the rate move alone. The $638bn backlog is the largest reported in the cycle and the least tested.

WATCH NEXT

> Thursday's print — backlog conversion, and any commentary on the cost of the next tranche of funding.

GOOGL

Alphabet Inc.

Capex $195–205bn (2026E)
$25bn bond, Aug 2026

The company that made the transition visible. Alphabet raised its 2026 capital-expenditure guidance twice, reported its first negative free cash flow since listing, and returned to the bond market in August for $25bn against roughly $115bn of peak demand. The deal cleared comfortably; the spread on its outstanding paper nonetheless widened with the cohort.

WATCH NEXT

> Whether free cash flow recovers next quarter, or whether negative becomes the run-rate condition.

NVDA

NVIDIA Corporation

Rev $96.2bn, +106%
Q2 FY27, 26 Aug 2026

Still the cycle's clearest beneficiary and its clearest coincident indicator. Data-centre revenue of $89.0bn was up 117% year on year at a 75.0% gross margin, with guidance of roughly $108bn for the current quarter that assumes no China data-centre compute at all. The internal view treats NVIDIA as the diversified way to own the bandwidth thesis.

WATCH NEXT

> Gross margin, guided down to about 74.0% — the first sequential compression in some time.

000660 KS

SK hynix Inc.

KRW 1,746,000
7 Sep 2026, +8.3%

The single best-levered listed proxy for the proposition that memory is now the largest line in AI capital spending. The shares rose 8.3% on 7 September as the KOSPI gained 4.61%, yet remain far below their 52-week high despite the export boom running through the company's order book. That gap is the market's scepticism about durability, expressed in a multiple.

WATCH NEXT

> Contract DRAM and HBM pricing — whether the volume boom is also a price boom, or only a price boom.

005930 KS

Samsung Electronics Co., Ltd.

+5.7% on 7 Sep 2026
KOSPI 6,995.39

The other half of a duopoly producing roughly two-thirds of the world's DRAM, and the reason Korean customs data now functions as an AI indicator. The internal Wiki records the tension plainly: record operating profits alongside a share price well below its all-time high, which it reads as investors declining to capitalise earnings they do not believe will persist through a capex cycle.

WATCH NEXT

> Whether the memory division's earnings keep offsetting loss-making consumer devices.

AMZN

Amazon.com, Inc.

Spread ~50bp → ~80bp
Sep 2026

Included here for its bonds rather than its shares. Amazon's March issue drew roughly $126bn of peak demand, among the largest order books of the year, and its paper sits at the centre of the spread widening that has taken large-cap tech from around 50 to around 80 basis points over Treasuries. It is the cleanest read on what lenders now charge the cohort.

WATCH NEXT

> The next multi-tranche deal from any hyperscaler — concession paid and order book relative to August's.

The bottom line

What was repriced over the past week was not artificial intelligence. It was the cost of building it. Korea's August export data settles, as far as any single series can, the question of whether the orders are real: $46.65bn of semiconductors in one month, up 209% on the year, is not a projection or a backlog but goods on ships. In the same days, the 10-year Treasury yield reached a one-year high, spreads on the cohort's paper widened towards 80 basis points, and the most indebted builder in the sector fell 4% without any news about its business. The market has begun to treat AI capital spending as a credit rather than a growth story, and credits are judged on their funding.

The evidence is genuinely mixed, and it should be said plainly that the two halves do not reconcile. Unit economics appear to have improved; demand, measured physically, is accelerating; the balance sheets carrying the debt are strong by investment-grade standards. Against that, free cash flow has turned negative at the largest spender, the obligations sitting off balance sheet are far larger than those on it and are not independently verified, and the buyer of last resort for this paper is being asked to choose between a technology company and a sovereign. The reasonable inference is that the constraint on this cycle has migrated from demand to funding, which means the things worth watching are auctions and spreads rather than product launches. The next test is close at hand: Oracle reports on 10 September and the Federal Reserve decides on 16 September, in that order.

Editorial note. This is educational commentary prepared for internal use. It is not investment advice, and it is not a recommendation to buy or sell any security. Companies named are illustrative of the mechanisms discussed and were selected because verified, dated figures exist for them. External figures carry their as-of dates and are drawn from company releases, exchange data and dated news reporting; they may have moved since. Internal figures and arguments are the views of the named research providers whose work sits in the Heyokha Wiki, are labelled as views rather than forecasts, and have not been independently verified. Where internal and external readings conflict, the conflict is stated and left unresolved rather than adjudicated. No figure that could not be traced to a dated source appears in this edition.

Sources and update notes

(a) Internal. Principal page: **AI Capex** (theme, created 23 June 2026, last reviewed 2 September 2026, 11,944 words), sections "Thesis", "The bull case", "The bear case & what breaks it", "Evidence & data", "Evolution" and "Contradictions". Provider issues relied on, with dates: **The White Box** (Ignacio de Gregorio) — 7 September 2026 ("Astra, fly brains & World Models": the JPMorgan Asset Management estimate that Big Tech bonds and SPVs emit more than 50% of US government issuance, over $320bn this year; memory above 50% of AI capex next year; Korean exports as the demand tell), 2 September 2026 ("The Five Horses of Bandwidth": inference as memory-bound, the bandwidth-enabler rule, silicon photonics at 50% of transceivers in 2027), 26 August 2026 ("The Truth & Lies of Data Centers": phantom interconnection queues, edge offloading unpriced in load forecasts), 22 August 2026 ("debt markets are beginning to send the invoice"; Alibaba's stated ~3-year payback), 28 July 2026 (the reversal on inference profitability), 4 June 2026 (capex per gigawatt $50bn heading to $100bn). **Greed & Fear** (Chris Wood) — 3 September 2026 ("Volcker Mark II?": the capex cycle as inflationary now, hyperscaler funding competing with the federal government, AI capex at 48% of US real GDP growth in the four quarters to 2Q26, labour share of output at a record-low 52.9%), 23 July 2026 (remaining performance obligations, hidden debt, the zaitech parallel). **CLSA** (Kestel) — 21 August 2026 (off-balance-sheet commitments near $3tn; depreciation above $520bn over three years). **13D Research** — 3 and 6 September 2026, consulted for the hard-asset and rate context.

(b) Limitation on the internal view. The AI Capex Wiki page is unusually concentrated in two providers. Of the thirty-four source summaries it cites, roughly twenty are The White Box and roughly eleven Greed & Fear; CLSA, 13D Research, Marc Faber, Gary Shilling and Goehring & Rozencwajg supply the remainder between them. Both dominant voices are directionally sceptical on financing — one has predicted "massive capital destruction" for most hyperscalers, the other has repeatedly warned on shadow borrowing while disclosing personal holdings in memory names. There is no dedicated bull-side provider on the page; the bull case as recorded is largely one sceptic's revision of his own prior view. Readers should assume the page systematically over-weights financing risk relative to a balanced survey, and that this edition inherits some of that tilt despite the external counterweight applied.

(c) External sources. (1) Korea Customs Service August 2026 trade data via Trading Economics, 1 September 2026: exports $98.25bn, +68.7% y/y; semiconductor exports $46.65bn, +209.0% y/y, 47.5% of exports, third straight month above $40bn, fifteenth straight month of growth; trade surplus $34.75bn; shipments to China +119.3%, to the US +89.3%. (2) Korea Customs Service 20-day August data via Korea Herald / Korea JoongAng Daily, 21 August 2026: exports $55.21bn, chip exports approximately $26bn. (3) NVIDIA Q2 FY2027 results release, 26 August 2026: revenue $96.2bn (+106% y/y, +18% q/q), data centre $89.0bn (+117%), GAAP and non-GAAP gross margin 75.0%, Q3 guidance approximately $108bn ±2% with non-GAAP gross margin

~74.0%, outlook assuming no China data-centre compute revenue. (4) Trading Economics US 10-year Treasury yield, 8 September 2026: 4.78%, down 2bp on the session, after a 20-month high near 4.788% at the start of the month. (5) Reporting on Oracle's 1 September 2026 decline of 4% on the yield move, and on $56bn of fiscal-2026 capex funded with $43bn of debt (Yahoo Finance / 24-7 Wall St., 1 September 2026). (6) Oracle Q1 FY2027 earnings date confirmed for Thursday 10 September 2026 after the close (company investor-relations release); remaining performance obligation of $638bn and cloud growth guidance of 58–64% per analyst previews, September 2026. (7) Bloomberg and associated reporting on Alphabet's August 2026 bond sale: $25bn raised, approximately $115bn peak order book, up to ten tranches from two to forty years; 2026 capex guidance $195–205bn, raised twice; first negative free cash flow since listing. (8) Issuance tallies: approximately $194bn sold by the largest cloud and AI issuers through July 2026, up about 79% year on year; approximately $220bn by early September; 2020–2024 average approximately $35bn a year and 2025 approximately $93bn; post-issuance leverage 0.4–0.7x versus an IG average near 3x (Vanguard, Fortune, Sage Advisory and MLQ compilations, July–September 2026). (9) Spread reporting: large-cap tech paper widening from around 50bp to around 80bp over Treasuries in September 2026 (CNBC and Janus Henderson commentary). (10) KOSPI close of 6,995.39 on 7 September 2026, +4.61%, with Samsung Electronics +5.7% and SK hynix +8.3%; SK hynix at KRW 1,746,000; Q2 2026 global DRAM revenue $154.73bn, +59.5% q/q, with the two Korean producers at roughly 64% of world output (Seoul Economic Daily, Investing.com, 7–8 September 2026). (11) FOMC meeting scheduled 15–16 September 2026 with the market weighing a hold at 3.50–3.75% against a 25bp increase following hawkish remarks from the chair (Marketplace, FedRateCalc, prediction-market pricing, 31 August – 8 September 2026). (12) CNBC, 3 September 2026, on whether Korea's tripling semiconductor exports are "too much of a good thing" — the external counterweight to the internal reading of the same data.

(d) Editorial choices in this automated run. The archive was read directly from the connected *HB Wiki Learning* folder rather than through the remote-devices bridge, which was not required; forty-one files were parsed and the thirty-day cooldown set was therefore verified in full rather than inferred. Entity scoring over Wiki sources published since 18 August ranked *Gold* highest at 21 points, but Gold ran on 26 August and is on cooldown, as are Silver Miners (3 September), Copper (19 August), Uranium (11 August), China Equities (21 August) and Defense — the last of which was published earlier today, 8 September, at 11:21 Hong Kong time. **AI Capex** was the highest-scoring eligible theme at 18 points and is not in the cooldown set: it last ran on 4 August, thirty-five days ago. Its hot signal was twofold — Greed & Fear's 3 September issue naming "the inflationary AI capex cycle" in its title, and The White Box's 7 September issue, published within three days. Two adjacent editions, AI Debt Financing (3 September) and Power Affordability (2 September), sit inside the cooldown window but are distinct filename topics; this edition deliberately takes the crowding-out and cost-of-capital angle rather than the financing-structure angle those covered, and confines itself to data published since. Non-theme entities that scored higher on raw signal — bond-bear-market, us-dollar, data-centers — were excluded because only pages typed as themes are eligible. No tool failures occurred: the Wiki MCP server, the archive folder and external search were all available throughout, though large Wiki responses had to be extracted programmatically rather than read whole.
